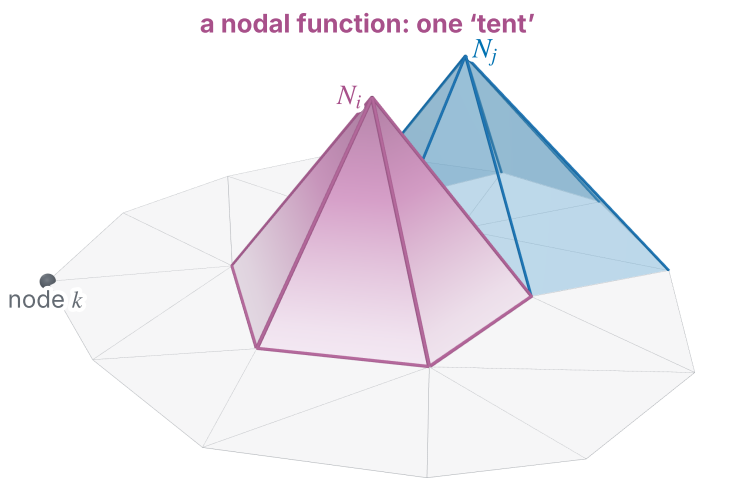
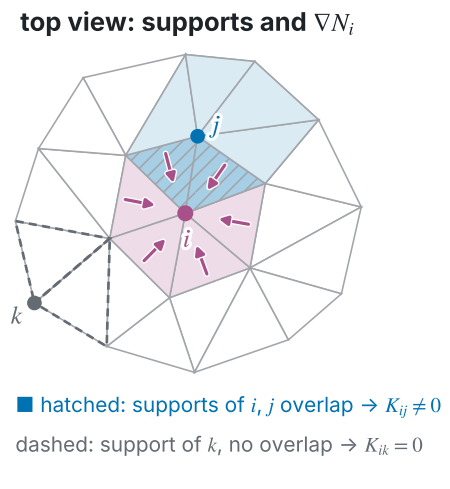

a nodal function: one ‘tent’
N_j
N_i
node k


top view: supports and ∇N_i
j
i
k
hatched: supports of i, j overlap → $K_{ij} \neq 0$
dashed: support of k, no overlap → $K_{ik} = 0$